

Unwrap UVW

One of the big benefits of polygonal modelling is that polygonal objects can have branches and multiple surfaces. This, however, makes it difficult to texture them with simple projections or 2D image placement.

The Unwrap UVW modifier is the best way to edit texture mapping on a complex polygonal object. It allows you to lay a wireframe representation of the object against a texture map and place textures exactly by adjusting the positions of the object's UV coordinates. The texture map contains images for all parts of the object. This map is placed inside a material and applied to the object.

The UVW Editor

Map Selection – Selects a map to display in the viewport.

View menu – Options to pan and zoom within the viewport.

Display menu – Options to hide, freeze, and show various parts of the viewport.

Options menu – Options for setting defaults.

Navigation tools – Tools to navigate the Editing viewport.

Rotate 90 – These will rotate the current selection by 90 degrees.

File menu – Options to load, save, and reset UVW coordinates.

Edit menu – Commands that provide access to the different transform functions, and copy-and-paste selections.

Select menu – Commands that let you copy a viewport selection to the editor, and transfer selections among the three different sub object modes.

Move/Rotate/Scale – Tools to let you move, rotate, and scale selected parts of the object. Editing viewport This is where the mapping of the object is matched to the bitmap. This can be navigated like a standard orthographic viewport.

Soft Selection – Tools to soft-select the geometry of the object.

Selection modes – Options to select by vertex, edge, or polygon. You can also select by element and paint selections.

Mapping menu – Lets you apply automatic, procedural mapping methods to a model. Each method provides settings so you can adjust the mapping to the geometry you're using.

Tools menu – Tools on this menu let you flip and mirror texture coordinates, weld vertices, combine and separate sets of texture coordinates, and sketch outlines for multiple selected vertices. 